

The Play

INTRO

"Hey (Client), this is (Your Name) — I'm calling regarding the loan you closed with (Lender) in (Year). At the time you mentioned you wanted a call when the rates dropped. Well, that's exactly why I'm calling today. So what would benefit you most right now: lowering the payment, shortening the term, or pulling some cash out of the equity?"

OBJECTIONS — ANSWER, THEN ASK. NEVER END ON A QUESTION THEY CAN SAY NO TO.

"I'm not interested."

You don't know what you're not interested in yet — I haven't given you a number. Ninety seconds and you'll either have

"I'm already working with someone."

Then you already know your numbers, this'll be quick. I'm not asking you to leave them. They're one lender — we run your file against our lender panel: banks, credit unions, wholesale — and take whoever comes back best. Either I beat their offer or I hand you proof they're the right call. What did they quote you? (Pivot)

"I already refinanced."

When did you close? (Wait for it.) Depending on that month, you either locked something great or you locked right before it got better. One number tells us which. What rate did you land? (Pivot)

"What's your rate?"

Anybody who fires a rate at you before asking about your credit and equity is making it up to keep you on the phone. I'm not doing that. Give me three numbers and you get a real one. Balance first — what are you sitting at? (Pivot)

"So you're not (Lender)?"

No — better. They're one lender with one set of rates. We're a brokerage: your file goes to multiple lenders, them included, and you take whoever wins. You get their offer plus everyone else's. What's your current balance? (Pivot)

"I don't want my credit run."

Not pulling anything today — nothing happens to your credit on this call. Ballpark your score and we work off that. If the numbers are good enough that you want to move, then we talk about a pull and I walk you through exactly what it does first. Ballpark — above or below 700? (Pivot)

"I don't want to start over on my loan."

You're not resetting to thirty unless you ask for it. Most clients hold their term or shorten it and still cut the payment. How many years are left on yours? (Pivot)

"Just send me something in writing."

I will — but anything I send before I have your numbers is a generic flyer you'll delete. Give me four minutes now and what

<i>lands in your inbox is your actual file with real figures on it. Best email? (Get it, then go straight back to discovery.) (Pivot)</i>
"I need to talk to my spouse."
<i>You should — and you should walk in with numbers, not a vague "somebody called." Let's get the figures now so you're presenting something real. Are they around later today or tomorrow? (Pivot — then book both of them on the callback.)</i>
"Call me back later." / "I'm busy."
<i>Understood — I'm not keeping you. Four minutes is all this takes and you never have to think about it again. If now truly isn't it: later today or first thing tomorrow? (Two options. Never "when's good for you.") (Pivot)</i>
"How'd you get my number?"
<i>You submitted a mortgage inquiry and it routed to us — that's the whole story, and I'm happy to note the file however you want. While I've got you: is your current rate something you'd improve if you could? (Pivot)</i>
DISCOVERY — DO NOT LEAVE THE CALL WITHOUT THESE
1. Current loan balance
2. Current payment — are taxes and insurance included?
3. Current rate
4. Estimated property value
5. Estimated FICO — ballpark is fine
6. Any late payments on the mortgage in the last 12 months?
7. (If cash-out) How much are you looking to pull, and what's it for?
Missing numbers kill the file. "I'd have to look" is not an answer — ballpark it with them on the phone. A file with seven real answers beats a file with three blanks.
CLOSE — ASSUME THE NEXT CALL
<i>"Good — I've got what I need. This goes to my finance director tonight and he runs it against our lenders. When we get back on, you'll see the actual numbers side by side with what you have now — and if we can't beat it, I'll tell you that in the first thirty seconds instead of wasting your afternoon. I've got tomorrow at 10 or tomorrow at 4. Which one?"</i>
<i>Two times. Never "when works for you." Once they pick, lock it and keep going.</i>
<i>"Last thing — assuming the numbers come back where I think they will, is there anything that would stop you from moving forward?"</i>
<i>Write the answer down word for word. That sentence is the real objection and it is the entire agenda for the next call. If they say "nothing," you just got a commitment — repeat it back to them: "So if the numbers work, we're moving. Got it."</i>
<i>"If something comes up, text me and I'll move it — just don't no-show me, I'm holding the slot. Best number to reach you?"</i>